Experiment 8: Case Study on the Business Impact of a No-Code Application Implementation

Aim

To study the business impact of replacing a manual process with a no-code application.

Objective

- Understand the problems of a manual business process.
- Study how a no-code application solves them.
- Measure the impact on time, cost, accuracy and user satisfaction.

Business Scenario

Sri Lakshmi Traders (illustrative small retail business) managed stock, customer orders and supplier payments in paper registers and Excel sheets kept by different staff members.

Problems before implementation

- Data entry errors and duplicate records.
- No live view of stock, causing stock-outs and over-ordering.
- Order status was known only by calling the staff.
- Month-end reports took several days to prepare.
- Only one person understood the Excel files.

No-Code Solution

The owner's team built an **Inventory and Order Management App** on a no-code platform (Zoho Creator) in about two weeks without hiring developers.

Feature	Description
Order form	Staff record customer orders from mobile or desktop
Stock tracking	Stock reduces automatically on every order
Low-stock alert	E-mail sent when an item falls below the minimum level
Dashboard	Daily sales, top products and pending orders
Approval workflow	Large purchase orders approved by the owner

Impact Analysis

Figures below are illustrative values to show the method of analysis; replace them with real data if you study an actual business.

Measure	Before	After	Improvement
Time to process an order	15 minutes	5 minutes	About 65% faster
Data entry errors per month	30	5	About 83% fewer
Monthly report preparation	3 days	Few minutes (auto)	Almost instant
Stock-out incidents per month	8	2	75% fewer

Measure	Before	After	Improvement
Development cost	Custom software quote: high	Low subscription cost	Large saving
Time to launch	3 - 4 months	2 weeks	Much faster

Benefits

- Faster delivery of the solution at lower cost.
- Business staff can modify the app themselves as needs change.
- Real-time data supports better decisions.
- Better customer service through quick order status.

Challenges

- Dependence on the platform vendor (vendor lock-in).
- Limits when very complex logic or custom design is needed.
- Staff training and data security need attention.

Results

The no-code application reduced processing time and errors, gave live visibility of stock and cut development cost and launch time compared with traditional development.

Conclusion

No-code platforms let small and medium businesses digitize their processes quickly and cheaply. When the platform is chosen carefully and data security is planned, the business impact is significant.